

DOCUMENT NNV-MQ | REV A | for mentors, clients and stakeholders

Mentor question card

Five questions that work at every stage, and what to add as the week goes on

Always (ask in this order)

1. **The decision.** Which single decision does your system make that, if wrong, hurts someone? Who?
2. **The region.** Over which inputs must it be right *always*? Name them, with units and ranges.
3. **The evidence.** What did you test it on — and what does that tell you about the inputs you did not try?
4. **The failure.** What would a counterexample look like, who would see it first, and what happens next?
5. **The signature.** Who chooses the threshold or the margin, and who signs?

Monday — pitch

- What does a human do today, without your system? That rule is your first specification.
- Which responsible-AI principle is this *about* — and how will we see it in the product, not the slides?
- Who is the end user you will actually talk to this week?

Tuesday — MVP

- Show me one input and one output. Now change one input a little: does the output move the way it should?
- Write your first property sentence: “for every ... in ..., the system must ...”.
- What is the accuracy claim, and on what?

Wednesday — Alpha

- Fill the worksheet (NNV-WS): the property in English and in pseudo-spec.
- Robustness: how much noise in the inputs may change the decision? Who decided that?
- Fairness: if a protected attribute is removed, what proxies remain?
- What is out of scope for verification here, and what covers it instead (testing, monitoring, a human)?

Thursday — Beta

- One table: *tested* (on what) · *monitored* (how) · *verified* (which property) · *governed* (who signs).
- Which assumption, if false, breaks the whole argument?
- What did a stakeholder object to, and what changed because of it?

Friday — final

- The assurance argument in sixty seconds, for a non-specialist.
- The honest paragraph: assumptions, limits, what you would do with another month.
- What would change your mind about deploying it?

Saying it back. “Your claim is X , measured on Y . It does not cover Z — say so, and say what does.” “That is a policy, not a property; who decides it?” “Good: that is a counterexample. Now, what changes?”